

The selnolig package: Selective suppression of typographic ligatures^{*}

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Abstract

The selnolig package suppresses typographic ligatures selectively, i.e., based on predefined search patterns. The search patterns focus on ligatures deemed inappropriate because they span morpheme boundaries. For example, the word `shelfful`, which is mentioned in the `TeXbook` as a word for which the `ff` ligature might be inappropriate, is automatically typeset as `shelfful` rather than as `shelfful`.

For English and German language documents, the selnolig package provides extensive rules for the selective suppression of so-called “common” ligatures. These comprise the `ff`, `fi`, `fl`, `ffi`, and `ffl` ligatures as well as the `ft` and `fft` ligatures. Other `f`-ligatures, such as `fb`, `fh`, `fj` and `fk`, are suppressed globally, while making exceptions for names and words of non-English/German origin, such as `Kafka` and `fjord`.

For English language documents, the package further provides ligature suppression rules for a number of so-called “discretionary” or “rare” ligatures, such as `ct`, `st`, and `sp`.

The selnolig package requires use of the `LuaATeX` format provided by a recent `TeX` distribution, e.g., `TeXLive 2013` and `MiKTeX 2.9`.

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^{*}Current version: 0.302. Features of the selnolig package are subject to change without prior notice.

The main text font used in this document is Garamond Premier Pro. EB Garamond is used for words that use the `fb`, `fh`, `fj`, `fk`, `ffb`, `ffh`, `ffj`, `ffk`, *es*, and *se* ligatures. “Common”, “discretionary”, and “historic” typographic ligatures are enabled for these text fonts—and are suppressed selectively using the rules of the selnolig package.

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